

Chapter 82-1

Among the four children of the Liang family, Liang Xinzhou was the most steady and composed.

He was the eldest son and had learned the most things since childhood. After the family had younger siblings, the attention on him wasn't as high anymore, but he would take the initiative to help look after his younger brother and sisters.

Liang Xinhe had a lively personality but was kind-hearted, and had been mischievous since he was young.

As for Liang Wanwan, no one knew who she took after—she had been introverted since childhood, didn't like to talk much, and always liked sitting in her room drawing or gazing at the sky alone.

When the nanny took her outside, she would just sit on the lawn pulling grass.

As for Liang Shi, there was no need to mention her—she had been rebellious since her teenage years, and it was only recently that there were signs of improvement.

It was also possible that she had changed because she found out she wasn't the Liang family's biological child.

Liang Xinzhou was only three years older than Liang Xinhe, so they could be considered to have grown up together, with a sense of companionship in their growth.

But Liang Shi was different.

When Liang Shi was born, Liang Xinzhou was already sensible. Father Liang was perpetually busy with work matters, and Qiu Zimin would occasionally be lazy and not pay much attention to this child.

So it was often Liang Xinzhou who helped take care of her.

It could be said that Liang Shi was practically raised single-handedly by Liang Xinzhou.

Aside from regular school days when Liang Xinzhou wasn't home, on rest days, apart from attending his extracurricular classes, Liang Xinzhou would play with Liang Shi.

Liang Shi was also sensible when she was little—like a tiny little bean, with her hair in princess braids, wearing a floral dress, toddling unsteadily behind Liang Xinzhou, calling out in a milky voice: "Big brother, gege¹."

By the time Liang Wanwan was born, Liang Xinzhou was already in high school and didn't have as much time to look after children.

So he wasn't that close to Liang Wanwan.

Liang Xinhe was alright though—he had always been carefree, and to him, both sisters were the same; he doted on them both.

He had never favored one over the other.

It was probably the experience of having younger siblings who were all quite a handful that made Liang Xinzhou mature early—he had almost never had a rebellious phase.

He arranged clearly what should be done at each stage and lived his life step by step.

Going to school, graduating, joining the company, getting married—except for being a step late in having children.

Everything else could be called a template life.

So he had never been hit at home.

Liang Xinhe was naughty when he was young, often playing with a bunch of delinquents and even gambling with people. After Qiu Zimin found out, she brought him back, and the couple administered a combined education.

Liang Xinhe was beaten quite badly.

Liang Xinzhou was different—he had never done anything out of line. When choosing his major for the gaokao², he scored very high marks, then discussed with his family which university to attend, became an exchange student during his undergraduate years, and applied to study abroad for graduate school—he was always the one who made his family most satisfied.

Yet in just half a month, Liang Xinzhou had been hit twice because of this matter.

And it was slaps to the face.

His roar had startled everyone, even making Liang Wanwan, who was sitting on the sofa, shiver.

Liang Xinhe said timidly: "Big brother..."

He wanted to mediate but didn't know where to start.

Liang Xinzhou took a deep breath. "This place was originally yours, so we'll move out."

"Liang Xinzhou!" Qiu Zimin shouted. "What did you say?"

Liang Xinzhou threw off her arm. "I said we're moving out. You can live with whoever you want."

"Also." Liang Xinzhou pulled Yu Wan and was about to turn and leave, but stopped halfway, paused, and then said: "Don't say things like having no right to speak. Yu Wan married me, so she has the right to speak equally with everyone in this family. The most basic thing you taught me—have you forgotten respect between people?"

After saying this, he pulled Yu Wan upstairs. Only then did Father Liang step forward to stop this farce. "What are you all doing? Do you want to turn this family upside down?"

"Liang Xinzhou, what do you mean?" Father Liang said. "Can't you be quiet tonight? Do you have to stir up trouble?"

"What I told you back then, you didn't take a single word to heart." Liang Xinzhou sneered coldly, his icy gaze sweeping toward Guo Xinran. Guo Xinran immediately lowered her head.

Liang Xinzhou said coldly: "Then you all can just carry on. I don't want to put on a fake smile in this family. I'm exhausted from work every day, and I don't want to come home only to face this kind of meaningless socializing. Morality is for restraining oneself, not for preaching to others."

After that, he pulled Yu Wan upstairs to pack their things and left the old residence that very night.

Liang Xinhe even tried to stop them at the door, but Liang Xinzhou nearly ran him over with his car.

Even though Liang Xinhe was blocking the doorway, Liang Xinzhou still stepped on the gas and charged forward. If Liang Xinhe hadn't run fast, he probably really would have been done for.

Then he suddenly realized that big brother's anger before couldn't even be called anger—at most, it was just intimidation.

This time, he was truly angry. His expression was so dark it could condense into ink.

After leaving the Liang family's old residence, neither Liang Xinzhou's nor Yu Wan's phones could be reached—they didn't answer calls or reply to messages. The two were completely out of contact.

At three in the morning, Liang Xinhe tried to contact Liang Xinzhou but couldn't reach him.

Shortly after the two left the old residence, Qiu Zimin was so angered from arguing with Liang Xinzhou that she cried until she fainted. She was sent to the hospital for examination and was on an IV drip until morning before she woke up.

Liang Xinhe stayed at the hospital all night. In the morning, he rushed home to take a quick shower and then came to the company to catch big brother, thinking he would apologize or something. But Liang Xinzhou had directly thrown in the towel.

He didn't even come to the company.

Liang Xinhe urgently handled documents all morning, feeling extremely frustrated. At noon, he went downstairs to get some fresh air and bought a cup of coffee while he was at it.

When he came back, he happened to run into Liang Shi.

¹ **Gege (哥哥)**: Chinese term for "older brother." The repetition of "Big brother, gege" shows the child speaking in an endearing, childish manner, using both the formal term and the more affectionate form.

² **Gaokao (高考)**: The National College Entrance Examination in China, a standardized test that is the sole criterion for admission to almost all higher education institutions in mainland China. It is extremely competitive and is considered one of the most important events in a Chinese student's life.